

## Sam Pitroda

Education is not just about homework and exams. Teachers have to become mentors, rather than just **PROVIDERS OF CONTENT.**



RAJKUMAR

India today needs to expand, to excel and also needs equity. These three ideas are all inter-related. One can't do without the other, and all three need to be done simultaneously. We can't afford to expand without focusing on excellence, we can't improve quality and not expand and we can't do all this and then not worry about equity, so that the poorest of the poor have access to all the resources. But to do all this, we need three major initiatives.

The first, of course, would be funding and resource allocation. That is something that has already been successfully accomplished with the Government allocating Rs 34,400 crore in

the 11th Plan. This is a great accomplishment and the Government should be complimented for putting money where its mouth is. But then just money is not going to get anything done.

This money needs to be used wisely, we need qualified people and teachers to head institutions and for this, we need a systematically planned deregulation just as we did in the telecom sector for over 10 years to provide a level-playing field and create a public and private partnership. This has been the key to its success. Such a partnership is important as the government alone is not capable of meeting needs and by holding on to this, it is delaying the process. There is a word of warning

19%

OF THE GROSS BUDGETARY EXPENDITURE HAS BEEN EARMARKED FOR EDUCATION IN THE 11TH FIVE YEAR PLAN, UP FROM 7.7% IN THE 10TH PLAN.